



PROGRESS REPORT

Gulf/UAE activities: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-02

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28 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	A Gulf digital memorandum in force since 2021 has produced no deliverable report, valuation or successor since 2023. Full record The memorandum has been in force since December 2021, its agreed heads a three-year digitalisation master plan, public-private-partnership and build-operate-transfer financing, and youth digital skills. The telecommunications ministry attributed the national cloud implementation project to it in February 2023. Nothing has been published since. No deliverable report, valuation or successor instrument exists on the record, the memorandum text itself is not published, and the ministry's account and the vendor's are the only sources for any of it. The national cloud it was credited with is now in operation, reported under data storage, and no source connects the delivered system back to this memorandum.	No change
Botswana	Heads of agreement with a Gulf counterparty on the private data centre are unchanged, and the counterparty is not named in the operator's latest quarterly account. Full record Heads of agreement with a Gulf counterparty were negotiated in March 2025 with site and technical planning progressed by September 2025; 2026-08-03 — the counterparty is not named in the operator's quarterly account. It is the only Gulf instrument the base holds for the country at any date, and the silence is the finding: the data centre it concerned is now commissioned and reporting revenue, reported under storage, with no statement of whether the agreement survived into the operating phase.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burkina Faso	A Gulf memorandum signed in September 2025 covers artificial-intelligence skills, digital infrastructure, electronic-government consolidation and cybersecurity, with nothing reported since. Full record 2025-09-22 — a memorandum was signed covering artificial-intelligence skills, digital infrastructure, electronic-government consolidation and cybersecurity. It is the only Gulf technology instrument the base holds, and nothing existed before it. No project, value, timetable or delivery has been reported in the eleven months since signature. Its four subject areas are precisely the four this report shows the state building on its own account — the roadmap, the data centres, the services portal and the security decrees — and no source connects any of that work to this memorandum.	Advanced
Burundi	One engagement is documented: a Qatari holding group announcing intended investment in cybersecurity, digital transformation and telecommunications. Full record The President received a Qatari delegation from a holding group, which announced intended investment in cybersecurity, digital transformation, telecommunications and banking. That is the only documented Gulf digital or data engagement the base holds, and the finding beside it is the more useful one: no Gulf-Burundi memorandum, framework agreement or loan specifically on digital or data was located. An announced intention by a private group, received at the presidency, is what stands in for a bilateral relationship here — no instrument, no value and no follow-up is on the record.	No change, one announced intention and no instrument
Central African Republic	A Gulf memorandum signed at Bangui in July 2026 couples digital finance and land banking, with no commitment figure, schedule or governance arrangement. Full record 2026-07-31 — a memorandum was signed at Bangui by the minister coordinating major works and strategic investments, covering digital finance and land banking, presented as mobilising investment for infrastructure while modernising land administration, with no commitment figure, disbursement schedule, timetable or governance arrangement stated. Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the only source under this subject the base holds; the counterparty is otherwise undocumented. It couples a payments ambition and a land-registry ambition under one offshore private counterparty, and registers as intent rather than finance. Land is the sensitive half. The country has already sold tokenised concessions with no functioning cadastre behind them, reported under the land register, and this memorandum proposes to modernise the register that sale ran ahead of.	Advanced
Comoros	No Gulf digital or telecom instrument is on file; the 16 megawatt solar and storage microgrid is Emirati-funded. Full record Searched at 31 August 2026, no memorandum, investment or project with a Gulf state or a Gulf company in the digital or telecommunications sector appears in the base at either end of the window. What exists is adjacent. 2026-04 - a 16 megawatt solar array with 9.1 megawatt-hours of battery storage was commissioned on Grande Comore, funded by the government of the United Arab Emirates and developed by a subsidiary of Masdar. Power is a precondition for digital infrastructure and is not itself a digital commitment. The submarine cable delivered in 2016 linking Grande Comore, Anjouan and Mayotte was laid by an Emirati marine contractor on other accounts; the record the base holds does not name one.	No change, the one Gulf commitment in the window is energy rather than digital

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cote d'Ivoire	Two non-binding memoranda signed in July 2025 have produced no work programme, deliverable or successor instrument. Full record 2025-07-15 - two non-binding memoranda were signed, one a framework for public-administration reform and digitalisation and one for the next national digital strategy. Thirteen months later no work programme, deliverable, successor instrument or vendor presence is on file. Neither memorandum has been published, so what either party undertook is not checkable, and the national digital strategy one of them was to feed has itself not appeared.	No change
Djibouti	No Gulf-state digital investment or cooperation instrument, figure or programme is held. Full record The position is unchanged at both ends of the window: ties strengthened with one Gulf state in November 2024 are mentioned in passing in a single source, and no instrument, figure or programme is held. It is a cited absence rather than an unexamined one. In a country whose whole external digital finance runs through three development lenders and one Chinese grant, and whose largest announced project is a memorandum with a Chinese promoter, the absence of Gulf engagement is a fact about the country's partners rather than about the base.	No change
DR Congo	The digital economy minister met a Gulf-based delegation on data-centre proposals in February 2026; talks only. Full record 2026-02 - the minister met a Gulf-based delegation on data-centre proposals, with a proposed technical-specification working group and no memorandum, site, capacity or follow-up recorded six months on. It is the whole of the relationship as the base holds it. No investment, agreement or presence has followed, and the working group that was proposed has produced nothing on record, so what is stated is an exploratory meeting rather than a commitment.	Advanced
Eswatini	A women digital academy was launched virtually under a bilateral memorandum signed at a United Nations General Assembly. Full record The academy launched in July 2026 under a memorandum signed at the 2025 General Assembly (academy). No cohort size, curriculum, funding or duration is published. It is the only delivered output of any Gulf arrangement in this ledger; the other, on power for the national data centre, remains an unsigned discussion.	Advanced
Ethiopia	A memorandum was signed between the two states' diplomatic academies, and technology appears as a dialogue theme rather than a commitment (dialogue). Full record The second Hili Africa Dialogue concluded in Addis Ababa in June 2026, at which a memorandum of understanding was signed between the Anwar Gargash Diplomatic Academy and Ethiopia's Institute of Foreign Affairs for research and capacity-building cooperation; its sessions discussed expanding cooperation in the digital economy and artificial intelligence (dialogue). The standing bilateral position is the joint ministerial statement of 6 January 2026, which reaffirms a comprehensive strategic partnership and covers Sudan, the climate presidency and water, and names nothing digital (statement). A December 2025 ambassadorial meeting explored cooperation in trade, investment, renewable energy and technology, agreeing to maintain momentum through the Joint Ministerial Commission (meeting). The engagement is real and the digital instrument is not: no Gulf memorandum, investment or ministerial readout names Ethiopian digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence or payments.	Advanced, on diplomatic and research cooperation rather than on any digital instrument

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Kenya	Seven memoranda were signed with the United Arab Emirates in May 2025, and consultations with Qatar were institutionalised in 2026. Full record Seven memoranda of understanding were signed at head-of-state level with the United Arab Emirates in May 2025 (signing). Consultations in Riyadh in July 2026 addressed frameworks to support diaspora welfare, rights and economic engagement (consultations). Bilateral political consultations with Qatar were institutionalised as annual in August 2026, the inaugural round led at principal secretary level (consultations). None of the three accounts names a digital instrument, a committed amount or a project among what was agreed.	Advanced
Lesotho	Labour arrangements are concluded with Qatar, before cabinet for the Emirates and at an advanced stage with Saudi Arabia. Full record 2026-02-05 — the Saudi ambassador reaffirmed an airport rehabilitation commitment while presenting credentials. 2026-05-27 — the minister separated concluded, cabinet-pending and advanced-stage bilateral labour arrangements across the Gulf states. 2026-06-05 — Lesotho pitched data-centre and multi-sector investment to Dubai Chambers, arguing from its water resources for cooling. The engagements on record are labour export and an investment pitch; no signed digital or data instrument with a Gulf state is held.	Advanced
Libya	Gulf engagement runs through two institutions: Arabsat for satellite capacity and the Islamic Development Bank for central bank training. Full record LTT and Arabsat announced a capacity partnership on 7 August 2026, with no commercial terms published (partnership). The Islamic Development Bank ran an executive programme in Jeddah in late July 2026 for central bank officials on cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence risk (programme). No Gulf sovereign fund, hyperscaler or bilateral digital agreement is recorded, so the relationship is institutional rather than financial.	Advanced
Madagascar	The President proposed a joint investment body with Saudi Arabia in December 2025, covering digital governance among other sectors. Full record A memorandum between an Emirati ports company and the investment board was signed in May 2024, exploratory in form with no committed amount and no named activity (memorandum). The President told a Gulf newspaper in December 2025 that the country aims to launch a secure national digital platform for public administration and security drawing on Saudi experience, and proposed a joint investment body covering digital governance (interview). Nothing in the base records an agreement signed, an amount committed or a project begun under either approach.	Advanced
Malawi	Five memoranda were signed during an Emirati visit in May 2025, one of them on digital learning. Full record 2025-05 - the Emirati foreign ministry's own account records five memoranda signed during a ministerial visit to Lilongwe, one a digital-learning cooperation agreement between a Gulf school programme and the government. 2025-11 - Malawi launched a Dubai-based climate-data platform built on machine learning and distributed ledgers at the climate conference. Both accounts come from the counterparty's side. Nothing Malawian on file states what either instrument commits the country to, what data the climate platform holds or where it holds it, and no investment figure attaches to any of it.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mali	A Gulf operator's US\$6bn connectivity pledge for 2024 to 2026 names the country among sixteen markets, undivided between them. Full record The pledge was made to an international connectivity coalition in March 2024 across sixteen markets including Mali and Niger (pledge). It is not broken down by country, so no Mali-specific allocation, project or delivery can be established from it. No other Gulf instrument, investment or agreement is recorded for the country.	Advanced
Mauritania	A cooperation agreement with Oman was signed in July 2026 across five instruments, and the Islamic Development Bank agreed US\$50m in principle in April. Full record The Omani agreement and accompanying memoranda cover digital capacity-building, electronic training, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and data analytics, platform development and civil-service programmes, signed at the close of a Nouakchott forum with no value disclosed by either side (agreement, forum). The development bank's agreement in principle covers digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, interoperability and skills, with no signed instrument, disbursement or schedule held (agreement in principle). Between them these are the largest recent commitments to the country's digital programme, and neither has a signed value on record (delegation, business forum).	Advanced
Mauritius	Cabinet approved a Saudi energy and cybersecurity memorandum for signature in August 2026, putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons. Full record It is an approval to sign rather than a signature, with no signing date, term, value or committed system, standard or spend (memorandum). It is the only Gulf engagement on record for the country, and the digital element is bundled inside an energy instrument rather than standing on its own.	Advanced
Mozambique	A Gulf environment memorandum moved past signature into a mixed technical team, and a Qatari conglomerate signed a US\$20bn strategic agreement covering six sectors. Full record 2026-02-03 — the agriculture ministry confirmed that a memorandum with the United Arab Emirates on environment and biodiversity has moved past signature, with a mixed technical team agreed to implement its action plan. It is the only Gulf instrument the base can show reaching an implementation mechanism. 2025-08-26 — a Qatari conglomerate and the government signed a strategic agreement valued at US\$20bn across agriculture, energy, infrastructure, health, education and tourism, the largest Gulf figure in the window. It is a private company's pledge, not a state financing instrument, and no drawdown, project or timetable is published against it. 2026-01-14 — a bilateral business roundtable reviewed cooperation across trade, gas, solar energy, port expansion, agriculture and artificial intelligence, the Emirati side citing bilateral trade of about US\$1.7bn in the first nine months of 2025, up 57.8 per cent. No digital-specific commitment is named in any of the three.	Advanced, one memorandum reached an implementation mechanism and a much larger private pledge was signed
Namibia	A bilateral economic commission with technology transfer and skills in its remit was proposed at a business forum in February 2026, with no agreement signed. Full record The commission's proposed remit covers technology transfer, skills development, industrialisation and manufacturing, and the Gulf side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements; no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published (proposal). The forum's own trade list runs to diamonds, scrap metal, charcoal, frozen fish and dates, with the ask being value addition before export, which is the context the technology element sits inside.	Advanced, proposal only

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	A Gulf operator's US\$6bn connectivity pledge for 2024 to 2026 names the country among sixteen markets, undivided between them. Full record The pledge was made to an international connectivity coalition at a mobile industry congress in March 2024 (pledge). It is not divided by country and no Niger-specific project, disbursement or value is published. No state-to-state Gulf instrument is found for the country.	Advanced
Nigeria	A comprehensive economic partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates was signed on 13 January 2026, the most significant Gulf instrument the base holds. Full record The agreement was signed on 13 January 2026 and explained publicly by the trade minister. The agreement text is not held, and no digital or data chapter is published, so what it carries for the digital economy is unestablished.	Advanced
Rwanda	A second data centre memorandum with a Gulf operator was reported in August 2026, and the record does not say whether the two describe the same facility. Full record Both are memoranda rather than financed builds, and both are with related entities from the same Gulf state; the record does not establish whether they describe one facility or two (second, first). No capacity, site, value or timetable is stated in either. Against a country with one national data centre of unpublished capacity and no hyperscale facility, two unpriced memoranda are the whole of the forward hosting pipeline.	Advanced
South Africa	Satellite connectivity services entered operation through a domestic venture and a United Arab Emirates operator, framed against the national broadband programme. Full record 2026-06-30 — satellite connectivity services entered operation in Johannesburg through a domestic venture and a United Arab Emirates operator, using that operator's next-generation and broadband infrastructure, framed against the national broadband programme and rural connectivity. No capacity, price, coverage or subscriber figure is published, and no licence instrument is named. The formal machinery of the relationship is old: the second session communique of the bilateral joint commission is the base's only record of it, eight years before this launch, with no later session or digital workstream on file. So the engagement that delivered a service has no visible instrument behind it, and the instrument on record has delivered nothing this base can name.	Advanced
Sudan	A Gulf-based processor signed a strategic processing agreement with a domestic bank for card-sponsored digital-payment processing, formalised at a regional trade event. Full record The agreement covers card-network-sponsored digital payment processing and was formalised at a regional technology exhibition (agreement). No value, term or volume is published. It is the only foreign commercial arrangement in the payments stack the base holds, alongside a revoked switch licence whose reported Gulf linkage the central bank never confirmed.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zambia	A co-operation agreement with a Qatari holding group and a joint business council with the Saudi chambers, over a US\$1.1bn mining stake. Full record An investment of up to US\$1.1 billion for 51 per cent of a copper mining company completed is the largest Gulf commitment in the country the base holds. 2025-08 – the state industrial corporation signed a co-operation agreement with a Qatari holding group covering energy, agriculture, tourism, mining, transport and logistics, witnessed by the President. 2025-09-18 – a chambers body and the Saudi chambers federation signed a memorandum establishing a joint business council, an institutional channel distinct from the two deals. Digital and data appear in none of them. The Gulf relationship here is mining and trade.	Advanced, and not about digital
Zimbabwe	An investment protection agreement with the United Arab Emirates is ratified and gazetted; a partnership agreement due by May 2026 was still unconcluded in August. Full record The promotion and reciprocal protection of investments agreement with the United Arab Emirates was signed in June 2018, approved by the National Assembly on 29 September 2020 and the Senate on 1 October 2020, and ratified by the President on 28 November 2020 (instrument). The two governments agreed in Dubai in February 2026 to conclude a comprehensive economic partnership agreement within three months, its proposed scope agriculture, mining, energy and infrastructure (talks). Three months past that deadline the Emirati minister of state met the President in Harare on 10 August 2026 to discuss economy, investment and trade, and no agreement was announced (meeting). The digital commitment on the base remains unsupported: a coding programme is running with the Emirates against a 1.5 million target, and the base holds no signed memorandum, value, delivery partner or enrolment figure behind it.	Mixed, a ratified investment treaty standing while a partnership agreement has run past the deadline its parties set

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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